

3. Should AI development teams be required to include individuals from diverse cultural, ethnic, gender, and socioeconomic backgrounds to ensure broader perspectives in model development?

Phase 1

I believe AI development teams should include diverse individuals to ensure fairer and more inclusive AI models. When AI is built by varied cultural, ethnic, gender, and socioeconomic backgrounds, it is less likely to contain biases that favor certain groups. Many AI models have failed marginalized groups due to lack of diversity in development teams. For example, facial recognition AI misidentifies darker-skinned individuals, and some models struggle to accommodate disabilities. AI impacts healthcare, hiring, finance, and criminal justice, making it unethical to develop it without diverse perspectives. Additionally, barriers related to gender, disability, and economic status prevent talented individuals from working in AI. Requiring diversity reduces bias and creates equal opportunities, ensuring AI serves all of society fairly.

Phase 2

Research strongly supports that diversity in AI teams improves fairness and innovation. A 2018 MIT study found that facial recognition AI had a 34.7% error rate for darker-skinned women but only 0.8% for lighter-skinned men, due to biased training data. McKinsey & Company reported that companies with higher diversity outperform competitors by 35%, while Harvard Business Review found that diverse teams make better decisions 87% of the time. Based on this, I believe AI teams should include diverse individuals to reduce bias, enhance fairness, and drive innovation. AI impacts global populations, so it must be developed by diverse teams to prevent unintentional bias in models.

Phase 3

While I still believe diversity is beneficial for AI teams, I now question whether hiring quotas are necessary. Society today is much more inclusive than in the past, and AI bias often stems from poor-quality training data, not just the developers' backgrounds. A Stanford study found that AI bias is largely due to flawed datasets, meaning improving data quality should be the main priority rather than enforcing diverse hiring. Another argument is that AI companies should prioritize technical expertise over diversity quotas. Harvard Business Review found that strict diversity mandates can create workplace tensions, as employees may feel hiring is based on politics rather than skill. Businesses compete in a global AI market, and if hiring is dictated by quotas rather than qualifications, it could slow innovation and progress.

Some also argue that forcing diversity is unrealistic in AI, where the priority should be developing the best models. Companies must hire the most skilled candidates to stay competitive, rather than focusing on race, gender, or cultural background when making hiring decisions.

Phase 4

After considering both sides, I still support diversity in AI, but I now believe that improving AI training data is more important than enforcing hiring quotas. While diverse teams help identify biases, diversity alone does not fix AI fairness if data remains flawed. I also recognize that hiring should be skill-based, not dictated by quotas. Instead of forcing diversity, companies should focus on fair hiring practices, mentorship programs, and outreach to underrepresented groups while still prioritizing expertise. My revised position is that AI teams should aim for diversity but not at the cost of hiring the most qualified individuals. The focus should be on better data, inclusive hiring policies, and fair opportunities without compromising AI innovation.

Phase 5

After reviewing both supporting and opposing perspectives, I conclude that AI development teams should prioritize diversity, but not through strict hiring quotas. While diverse teams bring valuable perspectives and help reduce bias, hiring should still be based on skills, experience, and technical expertise rather than enforced representation targets. Instead of focusing solely on who is hired, companies should ensure that AI itself is developed fairly by improving training datasets to eliminate bias, regardless of team composition. Additionally, businesses should implement ethical AI policies and bias-awareness training, helping developers recognize and address potential discrimination in models.

Creating inclusive hiring processes is still essential, but this should involve actively recruiting underrepresented talent rather than compromising technical standards. Companies can also support diverse mentorship programs, giving more opportunities for underrepresented groups to enter and grow in the AI industry. A strategic diversity approach, centered on fair hiring, representation, and inclusive AI practices, will lead to better AI models, reduced bias, and improved societal outcomes without undermining the technical excellence of AI development teams.